



InfoView', etc. It's probably easier, however, to just switch between channels 1, 6 and 11 until you find one that works well. (If you have two laptops, you can copy a file between them to test the throughput of each channel.) The great thing about 5GHz (802.11n and 802.11ac) – because there's much more free space at the higher frequencies – is that it offers 23 non-overlapping 20MHz channels!



Give it a third-party taste

Third-party custom made firmware for a router can provide you with tons of additional features and other utility benefits, however, they're more complex than vanilla firmware. From 'OpenWrt' and 'DD-WRT' to 'Tomato' and 'Chillifire', you have the freedom to choose the firmware that best suits you. Each package has its own pros and cons and special features besides the regular stuff, so it's definitely an option to consider if you want to turn your

standard home router into an enterprise one! Before loading either of these third-party solutions, however, check out their compatibility with your router.



Your preference matters

Quality of Service (QoS) is a mechanism on the network that provides certain traffic higher priority over other traffic that is less time-sensitive. If you're a gamer, frequent user of VoIP or a heavy video streamer, you can configure your router to allow these packets to be given priority over other packets such as that of email. This ensures that the prioritised packets are delivered and received faster. If a person has QoS configured for, say, VoIP, and a VoIP packet is in the network, the IP packets carrying VoIP are marked as priority packets. All networking equipment would then be configured to honor this marking and provide priority to these packets to ensure their smooth flow.

To set up your QoS, go to your router settings, locate the QoS menu and enter the category, bandwidth limits, applications and its priority, and you're all set to go!

Many people set up QoS hoping that it will do a world of good, only to report later that it doesn't didn't help. This happens because QoS only works when the bottleneck is in the right place and the key settings are your bandwidth declarations.



Go an extra mile to cover up the dead zones

People tend to look for newer model wireless routers in hopes of wiping out the dead spots that exist in most homes. To cover up these dead zones, there are two options: increase antenna gain or boost transmitting power, but at both ends. It's very important to upgrade antennas on both interfaces, so that they operate on higher gains for you to see the speed differences. An added advantage would be support to the 5GHz band.

If your router has detachable antennas, it makes sense to upgrade to higher gain antennas with dual-band support (if it's compatible) to show you the true capacity of the router. Higher power transmission will also increase the range of the router signal's cover.

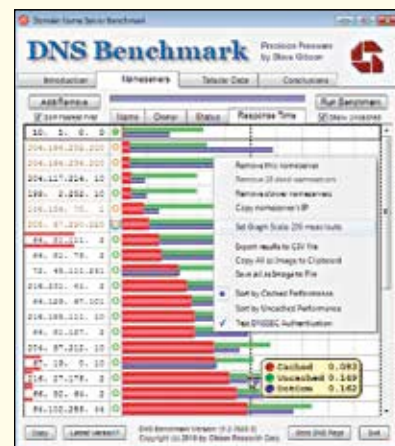
Nonetheless, if you can't upgrade the antennas right away, position your antennas correctly to cover better range. Antennas transmit signals perpendicularly, so to increase the range horizontally, keep the antennas vertical and vice versa.



Take charge of the DNS

Facing long response times, connection timeouts and cor-

rupt caches is quite common for some while browsing the internet. The DNS Name Resolution request isn't of much help in solving these issues. If not configured, we use the DNS provided by our ISPs, so why not go ahead and benchmark different public DNS servers to find the



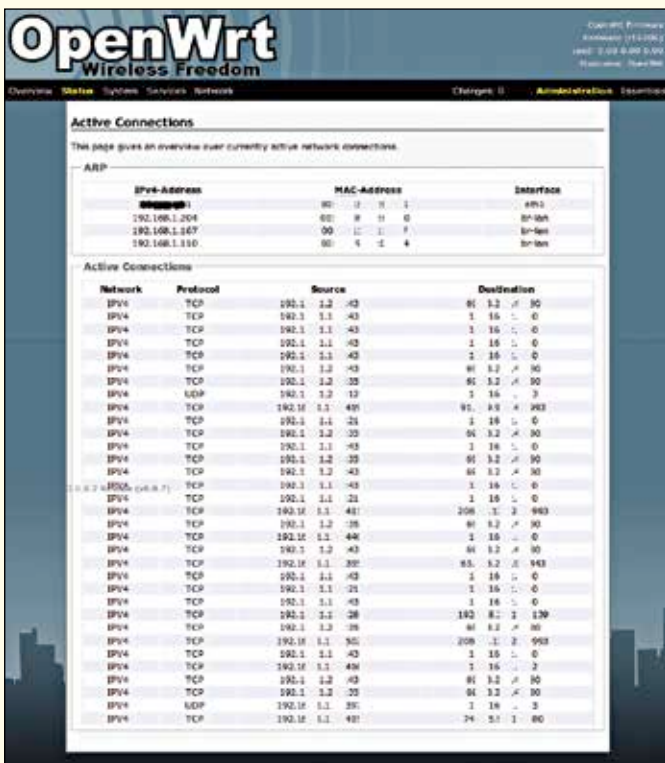
Check out the closest DNS server around you to access websites faster

best one for you? Download the DNS Benchmark from <https://www.grc.com/dns/benchmark.htm> and let it scan all the DNS servers around you to show you the best options to select from. 'Google DNS', 'OpenDNS', 'ScrubIT' and 'UltraDNS' provide public DNS servers as well as additional features such as adblock, firewall, parental website controls etc. If your ISP doesn't provide a speedy DNS server, ditch its server and choose one for yourself!



Create your own virtual router

Is your router giving issues? If you need to connect multiple devices over a network and your router isn't co-operating, go ahead and create your own router. A virtual router, that is. You can temporarily create a hotspot by using command prompt on Windows to turn your PC/laptop into a virtual router with its own Wi-Fi network. Connect the internet cable



Install a firmware which offers you more than the stock to access additional features!